Workplace Policies

Arbeitsplatzrichtlinie – Confidentiality, Harassment and Violence, Workplace Safety and Health

Document title	Workplace Policies
Document ID	NS-HR-POL-004
Version / status	2.1 / Approved and released
Effective date	01.01.2026
Next review	01.01.2027
Policy owner	Human Resources (HR), Julia Neumann, HR Director
Approved by	Dr. Katharina Weber, Managing Director (CEO)
Consulted	Works Council (Betriebsrat), Thomas Bauer; Safety Officer (Fachkraft für Arbeitssicherheit), Carlos Mendes; Data Protection Officer, Dr. Nadia Petrov
Applies to	All employees, contractors, volunteers, vendors and visitors at all Norvane Systems GmbH sites: Munich (HQ), Berlin, Garching and Frankfurt
Classification	Internal

Contents

1 Purpose and scope

2 Confidentiality and data protection

3 Harassment and violence (3.1 Workplace harassment, 3.2 Workplace violence, 3.3 Supporting victims, 3.4 Get help early on)

4 Workplace safety and health (4.1 Preventative action, 4.2 Emergency management, 4.3 Smoking, 4.4 Drug-free workplace)

5 Key contacts

6 Related documents and version history

1 Purpose and scope

Our workplace policies help us build a lawful and pleasant workplace where our employees can thrive. This document sets out Norvane Systems' basic workplace policies on confidentiality, health & safety and anti-violence practices, and forms part of our Employee Handbook.

This section describes workplace policies that apply to everyone at our company: employees, contractors, volunteers, vendors and stakeholders alike. These policies help us build a productive, lawful and pleasant workplace.

Keep in mind that this policy is not a legal document and may not take into account all relevant local or national laws. If you have any questions about it, please contact HR.

> **Disciplinary measures and German employment law.** Measures described in this policy (for example "termination") are applied in line with applicable German employment law. Where required, a written warning (Abmahnung) is issued first, and the Works Council (Betriebsrat) is heard before any termination.

2 Confidentiality and data protection

We want to ensure that private information about clients, employees, partners and our company is well-protected. Examples of confidential information are:

Category	Examples	Responsible department
Employee records	Personnel files, payroll data, performance reviews	HR
Unpublished financial information	Budgets, forecasts, unreleased results	Finance
Data of customers/partners/vendors	Contracts, pricing, contact data, project documentation	Sales, Procurement, Legal
Customer lists (existing and prospective)	CRM exports, lead lists	Sales
Unpublished goals, forecasts and initiatives marked as confidential	Strategy papers, product roadmaps	Executive team

Personal data is processed in accordance with the General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR, German: DSGVO) and the German Federal Data Protection Act (BDSG). Questions about data protection can be sent to our Data Protection Officer, Dr. Nadia Petrov (privacy@norvane.example).

As part of our hiring process, we may ask you to sign non-compete and non-disclosure agreements (NDAs.) We are also committed to:

- Restrict and monitor access to sensitive data.
- Develop transparent data collection procedures.
- Train employees in online privacy and security measures.
- Build secure networks to protect online data from cyberattacks.
- Establish data protection practices (e.g. secure locks, data encryption, frequent backups, access authorization.)

We also expect you to act responsibly when handling confidential information.

You must:	You must not:
• Lock or secure confidential information at all times. • Shred confidential documents when they’re no longer needed. • Make sure you view confidential information on secure devices only. • Only disclose information to other employees when it’s necessary and authorized. • Keep confidential documents inside our company’s premises unless it’s absolutely necessary to move them.	• Use confidential information for your personal benefit or profit. • Disclose confidential information to anyone outside of our company. • Replicate confidential documents and files and store them on insecure devices.

This policy is important for our company’s legality and reputation. We will terminate any employee who breaches our confidentiality guidelines for personal profit.

We may also discipline any unintentional breach of this policy depending on its frequency and seriousness. We will terminate employees who repeatedly disregard this policy, even when they do so unintentionally.

3 Harassment and violence

To build a happy and productive workplace, we need everyone to treat others well and help them feel safe. Each of us should do our part to prevent harassment and workplace violence.

3.1 Workplace harassment

Harassment is a broad term and may include seemingly harmless actions, like gossip. We can’t create an exhaustive list, but here are some instances that we consider harassment:

- Sabotaging someone’s work on purpose.
- Engaging in frequent or unwanted advances of any nature.
- Commenting derogatorily on a person’s ethnic heritage or religious beliefs.
- Starting or spreading rumors about a person’s personal life.
- Ridiculing someone in front of others or singling them out to perform tasks unrelated to their job (e.g. bringing coffee) against their will.

Sexual harassment is illegal and we will seriously investigate relevant reports. If an employee is found guilty of sexual harassment, they will be terminated. Harassment and discrimination are also prohibited under the German General Equal Treatment Act (AGG). HR acts as our internal complaints office (Beschwerdestelle) under the AGG.

If you’re being harassed, whether by a colleague, customer or vendor, you can choose to talk to any of these people:

Contact	When to choose this option
Offenders	If you suspect that an offender doesn’t realize they are guilty of harassment, you could talk to them directly in an effort to resolve the harassment. This tactic is appropriate for cases of minor harassment (e.g. inappropriate jokes between colleagues.) Avoid using this approach with customers or stakeholders.
Your manager	If customers, stakeholders or team members are involved in your claim, you may reach out to your manager. Your manager will assess your situation and may contact HR if appropriate.
HR	Feel free to reach out to HR in any case of harassment no matter how minor it may seem. For your safety, contact HR as soon as possible in cases of serious harassment (e.g. sexual advances) or if your manager is involved in your claim. Anything you disclose will remain confidential. Contact: hr@norvane.example, ext. 2000.

3.2 Workplace violence

Violence in our workplace is a serious form of harassment. It includes physical and sexual assault, destruction of property, threats to harm a person or property and verbal and psychological abuse. We want to avoid those incidents altogether, but we also want to be ready to respond if needed.

For this reason, we ask you to:

- Report to HR if you suspect or know that someone is being violent. Your report will be confidential and we will investigate the situation with discretion.
- Call our building’s security (ext. 9111) if you witness incidents of severe physical violence (e.g. ones that involve a lethal weapon.) For your safety, avoid getting involved. In a life-threatening situation, call the emergency services (112) or the police (110).

We will treat employees who verbally threaten others as high risk and they will receive an appropriate penalty. If HR finds that an employee commits an act of violence, we will terminate that employee and possibly press criminal charges. Employees who damage property deliberately will be solely responsible for paying for it.

3.3 Supporting victims

To support victims of workplace violence, we may:

- Cover relevant medical bills.
- Pay for mental health treatment if needed.
- Provide victims with our lawyer’s services to help them file lawsuits.

3.4 Get help early on

Seek help from others early on to mitigate conflicts. For example:

- If you experience conflicts with a colleague, ask your manager for advice before tensions escalate. If these conflicts persist, ask HR whether you could attend conflict resolution seminars with your colleague.
- If you are experiencing personal or work troubles, ask for help from a mental health professional. Check with your insurance provider (Krankenkasse) to determine whether they cover any mental health services or ask HR (hr@norvane.example) for information on our Employee Assistance Program (EAP). Your discussions will remain confidential.

Our workplace is founded on mutual respect and we won’t allow anyone to compromise this foundation.

4 Workplace safety and health

Our company is committed to creating a hazard-free workplace. To this end, we will ensure workplace safety through preventative action and emergency management.

4.1 Preventative action

Preventative actions are any actions we take to avoid injuries or illnesses related to the workplace. We will periodically conduct risk assessments (Gefährdungsbeurteilung) and job hazard analyses through our Workplace Safety Committee (Arbeitsschutzausschuss) to uncover health risks to employees. The committee meets at least once per quarter and is chaired by Carlos Mendes, Safety Officer. And we will establish preventative measures to address risks accordingly.

At a minimum, we will:

- Hold employee training sessions on safety standards and procedures.
- Make sure employees who work in dangerous locations are safe.
- Provide protective gear like gloves, protective uniforms and goggles.
- Direct inspectors and quality control employees to evaluate equipment and infrastructure regularly.

We also expect you to take safety seriously. Always use protective equipment and follow standards whenever necessary. If you deliberately disregard our guidelines, we may terminate you for your own and others’ safety.

4.2 Emergency management

Emergency management refers to our plan to deal with sudden catastrophes like fire, floods, earthquakes or explosions. Our emergency management provisions include:

- Functional smoke alarms and sprinklers that are regularly inspected.

- Technicians (external or internal) available to repair leakages, damages and blackouts quickly.
- Fire extinguishers and other fire protection equipment that are easily accessible.
- An evacuation plan posted on each floor and online.
- Fire escapes and safety exits that are clearly indicated.

Site	Assembly point (Sammelplatz)	Evacuation plan
Munich HQ, Parkring 12	Courtyard, north side	Posted on each floor and on the intranet
Berlin office	Front forecourt	Posted on each floor and on the intranet
Garching hardware depot	Parking area P2	Posted at each gate and on the intranet
Frankfurt data center	Gate A	Posted at the entrance and on the intranet

Emergency numbers: emergency services 112 · police 110 · building security ext. 9111 (24/7, HQ).

4.3 Smoking

Norvane Systems is a smoke-free workplace. You can smoke in designated smoking areas, balconies, open-air verandas and outer premises, like gardens and sidewalks. Any other area in our workplace (like restrooms, lobby, offices, staircases, warehouses) is strictly smoke-free to protect non-smokers. This also applies to e-cigarettes and vaping devices.

Site	Designated smoking area
Munich HQ	Courtyard terrace (ground floor)
Berlin office	Roof terrace
Garching hardware depot	Marked area outside Gate 2
Frankfurt data center	Smoking is not permitted on site, including outdoor areas inside the fence

We also advise you to:

- Extinguish your cigarettes and discard them in outdoor ashtrays, cigarette urns.
- Avoid smoking when you have scheduled meetings with clients or vendors.
- Avoid smoking near flammable objects and areas.

Setting off fire alarms and causing fires by smoking are serious offenses. If you are found responsible, you may face disciplinary action up to and including termination.

4.4 Drug-free workplace

Norvane Systems is a drug-free workplace. Whether you are an employee, contractor or visitor, you must not bring, use, give away or sell any drugs on company premises. If you are caught with illegal drugs, or show that you are under the influence of substances, you will face disciplinary action up to and including termination. Under DGUV Regulation 1, nobody may work while impaired by alcohol, drugs or other intoxicating substances in a way that endangers themselves or others.

A list of prohibited drugs and substances includes, but isn’t limited to:

- heroin/cocaine/methamphetamine in any form
- marijuana and other cannabis products, including consumption that is legal for adults under the German Cannabis Act (KCanG), on company premises and during working hours

Alcohol

We prohibit employees from consuming alcohol during working hours, but they may consume alcoholic drinks in moderation at company events.

Prescription drugs

If you feel that a prescription drug (e.g. an anxiety medication) unexpectedly affects your senses, thinking or movement, ask for the rest of your day off. If your manager suspects substance abuse, you may face disciplinary action.

You must not use medical marijuana (medical cannabis) in our workplace. We have the right to terminate you if your off-duty use of medical marijuana makes you unable to complete your job duties correctly.

We expect employees who hold safety-sensitive jobs (e.g. machine operators or drivers) to be fully alert and capable of performing their duties at all times. We may terminate you if we conclude your prescription drug use creates severe safety risks. If you need to use prescription drugs for a limited time and you think they may impair your abilities, use your PTO or sick leave.

If your job includes secondary tasks that are safety-sensitive and your prescribed drugs affect your ability to perform these tasks, we can make reasonable accommodations to ensure you and your colleagues' safety.

Dealing with addiction

Being sober is a prerequisite to thriving at our company and we want to help you as much as possible. We offer Employee Assistance Programs (EAP) that can help employees overcome addictions. If you face a relevant problem, please reach out to our EAP Officer, Mariam Haddad (eap@norvane.example, ext. 2010).

We won't tolerate substance addiction that results in violent, offensive or inappropriate behavior.

Overview of consequences

Situation	Possible consequence
Breach of confidentiality for personal profit	Termination
Unintentional breach of confidentiality	Discipline, depending on frequency and seriousness
Repeated disregard of the confidentiality policy, even if unintentional	Termination
Sexual harassment	Termination
Verbal threats against others	Treated as high risk; appropriate penalty
Act of violence	Termination; possibly criminal charges
Deliberate damage to property	Employee is solely responsible for paying for it
Deliberate disregard of safety guidelines	Possible termination
Setting off fire alarms or causing fires by smoking	Disciplinary action up to and including termination
Illegal drugs or being under the influence on premises	Disciplinary action up to and including termination

5 Key contacts

Role	Name	Email	Phone / extension
Human Resources (general)	HR team	hr@norvane.example	ext. 2000
HR Director	Julia Neumann	julia.neumann@norvane.example	ext. 2001
EAP Officer / HR Business Partner	Mariam Haddad	eap@norvane.example	ext. 2010
Safety Officer (Fachkraft für Arbeitssicherheit)	Carlos Mendes	carlos.mendes@norvane.example	ext. 2400
Works Council (Betriebsrat)	Thomas Bauer, Chair	betriebsrat@norvane.example	ext. 2500
Data Protection Officer	Dr. Nadia Petrov	privacy@norvane.example	ext. 2600
Ethics hotline	Compliance	ethics@norvane.example	ext. 2650
Building security (HQ)	Security desk	security@norvane.example	ext. 9111 (24/7)
Emergency services / police	–	–	112 / 110

6 Related documents and version history

Document ID	Title
NS-HR-POL-001	Code of Conduct
NS-HR-POL-002	Leave and Absence Policy
NS-IT-POL-001	Information Security Policy
NS-LEG-POL-001	Data Protection Policy
NS-EHS-PRC-001	Emergency and Evacuation Procedure

Version	Date	Change	Author
2.1	01.01.2026	Added site-specific smoking areas, cannabis clause (KCanG) and consequences overview	Julia Neumann
2.0	01.03.2025	Annual review; aligned with GDPR/DSGVO and AGG; Works Council consulted	Julia Neumann
1.0	15.01.2023	First release	HR

Norvane Systems GmbH · Parkring 12, 80339 München, Germany · Tel. +49 89 99998-100 · www.norvane.example
Managing Directors (Geschäftsführer): Dr. Katharina Weber, Lukas Brandt · Registered office: München · Amtsgericht München, HRB 287654 · VAT ID: DE312874596